

Submission Worksheet

Submission Data

Course: IT265-002-S2026

Assignment: IT265 Case Study - Personal Choice

Student: Daniel K. (dk72)

Status: Submitted | **Worksheet Progress:** 100%

Potential Grade: 10.00/10.00 (100.00%)

Received Grade: 0.00/10.00 (0.00%)

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Updated: 5/7/2026 3:15:41 PM

Grading Link: <https://learn.ethereallab.app/assignment/v3/IT265-002-S2026/it265-case-study-personal-choice/grading/dk72>

View Link: <https://learn.ethereallab.app/assignment/v3/IT265-002-S2026/it265-case-study-personal-choice/view/dk72>

Instructions

Step 1: Pick a game you plan to analyze

Step 2: Playtest your game choice (or review streamers playing the game)

Step 3: Analyze, research, and review your chosen game. Collect resources (website links, etc that you used during the exploration) include these with the responses in the related sections. Fill in the responses of the below prompts/checklist/etc.

Step 4: Export the PDF. Upload it to Github and upload the same PDF to Canvas.

Section #1: (1.25 pts.) Game Overview

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Historical Context and Game Description

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Game's title, developer, publisher, platform, and release date.
- Historical context of the game's release and its place in the industry.
- Game's genre and how it compares to similar games of the time.

Your Response:

Cyberpunk 2077 was developed & published by CD Projekt Red. It was officially released to PC & console markets during 2020. CD Projekt Red is known for their incredibly well renowned Witcher series, cementing the studio's legacy in the gaming

incredibly well-reviewed Witcher series, cementing the studio's legacy in the gaming world. Cyberpunk 2077 was released during the start of the Pandemic and was notorious for its unfinished state and numerous bugs and glitches, some of which are still being fixed to this day. Cyberpunk 2077 is an action RPG with multiple endings and one DLC that explores an alternate path the protagonist, V, can take.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Gameplay Mechanics

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Discuss the core gameplay mechanics and how they shape the player's experience.
- Explain how players control the game and interact with it.
- Identify and describe any unique aspects or creative elements in the game's gameplay.

Your Response:

Gameplay revolves around completing story missions and small side quests to level up, acquire skill points for the talent tree, and purchasing new weapons and cyberware to take advantage of these talents. Certain rare weapons have unique effects that are found nowhere else in the game, and require certain conditions to obtain. Players can explore Night City on foot or by using any vehicle (stolen or purchased). Some quests can only be started by exploring the map and going to the corresponding marker. Combat shines by promoting varied playstyles. Stealth can be emphasized to complete certain objectives while going in guns blazing is always an option should you get detected. Quickhacks allow the player to dictate the flow of combat too. This can be done by targeting enemy NPCs and selecting which quickhack you want to use. The environment has some elements vulnerable to quickhacking (vehicles, cameras) allowing you to get into otherwise inaccessible areas.



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Section #2: (1.25 pts.) Software Architecture And Technology

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Technical Framework

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the game engine and any special software (middleware) used to make the game. Explain why these were important for making the game work.
- List the programming languages and software tools used to build the game. Discuss how these tools helped in creating the game's features.

Your Response:

Cyberpunk 2077 was developed with CD Projekt Red's in-house REDengine 4. While this engine was used for the previous Witcher games, it had to be completely rebuilt to support the demands Cyberpunk 2077 needed. The NPC density and open world environment necessitated this engine rebuild. C++ is the primary programming language & supports global illuminated ray tracing.

<https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=33364745>



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Innovations and Challenges

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Identify and describe any new or unique technical features in the game. Explain how these features made the game different or improved it.
- Discuss any major difficulties the developers encountered while making the game. Describe how they solved these problems.

Your Response:

Cyberpunk 2077 was notorious for its buggy, unfinished launch state where many half measures were taken to ship the game after a lengthy development cycle. Since release, the game has underwent numerous updates that have either fixed or alleviated a multitude of these bugs and glitches, significantly increasing the quality of the game and adding new events and equipment to find in the map.

Crowbcat Youtube Video demonstrating some of these difficulties:

<https://youtu.be/omyoJ7onNrg?si=peTw8W1GW-42H0K3>



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Section #3: (1.25 pts.) Gameplay Mechanics And Level Design

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Mechanics Analysis

Details:

- Explore and describe the main rules and actions that players use in the game. Explain how these core mechanics define the game's playstyle.
- Discuss how the game's core mechanics keep players interested and involved. Describe the ways these mechanics make the game fun or challenging.

Your Response:

The core gameplay loop of Cyberpunk 2077 is completing quests, acquiring loot, and upgrading your loot. This comes in the form of cybernetic augmentations, weapons, and quickhacks. The loot you can gather can promote certain playstyles from a quickhack playstyle, ranged playstyle, or melee playstyle. Completing quests gives you XP to gain skill points. These skill points are used to spec into whatever playstyle you prefer. Personally I preferred a quickhack centric build with a secondary melee component.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Level Design

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the design of the game's levels or environments. Focus on the layout, obstacles, and visual elements, and how they contribute to the game's setting.
- Explain how the level or environment design affects the way players play the game. Discuss how these design choices impact the overall experience, such as creating challenges, guiding the player, or setting the mood.

Your Response:

The environment of Night City is expansive and dense. Some areas of the city are controlled by certain factions, and depending on what you do during missions it can affect your reputation with these groups. Environments have cameras all over to quickhack, and from there you can indirectly defeat enemies. The layout of these areas and obstacle placement allows the player to choose whatever playstyle they want.



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Section #4: (1.25 pts.) Graphic And Audio Design

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Graphic and Audio Design

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the game's visual appearance and the artistic choices made. Discuss elements like color, art style, and thematic consistency, and how they contribute to the game's overall look and feel.
- Discuss the design of the game's characters and environments. Focus on aspects such as realism, creativity, and how they fit within the game's world. Explain how these designs enhance the player's immersion in the game.

Your Response:

The visuals of Cyberpunk focus on realism with some stylistic exaggerations for the cyberpunk aspects of Night City. The city as a whole fits the dystopian capitalist hellscape that environmental context clues slowly show you. The story itself shows how deep it goes. The characters are all products of the Night City environment and their attitudes show it.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Audio Design

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Examine the game's sound design, focusing on the music and sound effects. Describe how they are used and their quality. Discuss any memorable or unique audio elements in the game.
- Explain how the game's audio contributes to its overall mood and setting. Discuss how sound and music influence the player's emotional response and enhance the gaming experience.

Your Response:

The sound design is incredible and expansive, and often shifts itself to reflect the in-game state and environment. Certain sound cues play when you make an impactful choice, and the soundtrack changes when consequences are made apparent.



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Section #3 (1.25 pts.) User Interface And User Experience

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - User Interface and User Experience

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the layout of the game's user interface (UI) and how it functions. Discuss elements like menus, icons, and on-screen prompts, and how they help players navigate and understand the game.
- Evaluate how well the game's UI communicates important information to players. Discuss aspects such as clarity, readability, and the ability of the UI to provide necessary game details without overwhelming or confusing the player.

Your Response:

The UI is a classic HUD that shows enemy locations, markers, ammo count, health, etc. all stylized to make sense within Cyberpunk's technological aesthetic. It is communicative and tutorial screens can be found on first interaction to explain game mechanics. Overall it is nonintrusive and communicates to the player exactly what is happening.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - UX Analysis

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Discuss the overall feel of playing the game, focusing on how different aspects of the game contribute to the player's experience. Analyze how these elements, such as ease of use, game flow, and feedback, affect the gameplay.
- Evaluate the design decisions made to enhance the player's experience. Consider factors like tutorial design, learning curve, and player engagement. Discuss how effective these choices are in making the game enjoyable and accessible to players.

Your Response:

The learning curve of the game is not steep, but the floor is accessible enough for anyone to learn how game mechanics interact. The tutorials themselves serve as good introductory material but they do not go into the nuance of combat and other game mechanics.

Section #6: (1.25 pts.) Narrative And Storytelling

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Narrative Structure

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the game's story, including its narrative structure, main plot points, and the setting in which it takes place. Discuss how these elements come together to create a cohesive and engaging story.
- Analyze the storytelling techniques used in the game, such as dialogue, cutscenes, or environmental storytelling. Evaluate how effectively these techniques convey the story and engage the player.

Your Response:

Cyberpunk's story is fairly linear, though certain choices affect what you can do and where you go. There are different life paths you can choose, but they don't really change the overall experience aside from dialogue and interaction options. Plot threads are brought up and accompanying side quests take you all over Night City to resolve them and give you further information on you, Johnny Silverhand, and the events of Night City.

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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Character and Integration

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Discuss the development of the game's characters. Describe their roles within the story, their personalities, and how they evolve throughout the game. Consider how the characters contribute to the overall narrative.
- Examine how the game's narrative and characters are integrated into the gameplay. Discuss how story elements are woven into the game mechanics and how this integration affects the player's experience.

Your Response:

Cyberpunk's characters all serve a purpose on V's journey. Jackie Wells is perhaps one of the most beloved characters even though he dies early on in the story. He shows

just how ruthless Night City can be to everyone within it and how every action has consequences. Johnny Silverhand is V's companion and you have to work together as the Relic in your head slowly rewrites your DNA, and depending on how you treat him he will respond to you in different ways. This can open or close certain choices and in one case, determine what ending you get late into the game.



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Section #7: (1.25 pts.) Impact And Reception

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Reception and Impact

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Research and summarize how the game was received by critics and players. Include key reviews, ratings, and player feedback. Discuss any notable praise or criticism the game received.
- Analyze the game's impact on the gaming industry. Discuss how it may have influenced game design, trends, or inspired other games. Consider any lasting effects it has had on the industry.

Your Response:

On release, the game was slammed for its terrible optimization, bugs, game-breaking glitches, and generally poor quality control indicative of a rushed development cycle in order to meet the release deadline. This came after numerous delays and a bloated budget. Otherwise, the game was praised for its deep story and choices. The most notable thing was CD Projekt Red releasing an apology video. Cyberpunk's impact on the games industry is still felt to this day both as what not to do and as a redemption story.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Cultural Significance

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Examine the game's cultural significance and the legacy it has left behind. Discuss how the game has been remembered over time and its status in the gaming community.
- Describe the game's presence and representation in media, such as films, books, or online content. Discuss its role in fan communities and any influence it has had on broader cultural aspects, such as art, music, or social trends.

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Your Response:

The game's launch is perhaps its most well known, and infamous, legacy. Shadows of Cyberpunk's legacy can be seen in all sorts of games launching (and sometimes failing, think Concord). The game has a dedicated community around it that explore the game's remaining mysteries and generally just have fun with new builds and more.



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Section #8: (1.25 pts.) Reflection

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Describe your personal experience playing the chosen game

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Was it "fun"? What made it fun or not fun?
- Is this genre/game-type aligned with personal interests?
- What made you pick this game? Was it a good choice?

Your Response:

I have around 80-100 hours in the game and I enjoyed my time with it. I found that it aligned with my interests and my propensity to optimize preferred builds that suited my playstyle. I chose this game because I had a lot of time with it and I already had some knowledge pertaining to it, lessening my need to research into the game compared to other options.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Assignment Reflection

Progress: 100%

Details:

- What interesting or new "thing(s)" did you learn during your research and analysis?
- Did you find it was easy to come across the information you were looking for? What was your primary means of research/analysis?

Your Response:

your response.

I learned a lot about the effort that went into the game despite it's troubled launch and its slow but measurable redemption over time. Information was easy to find as coverage of the game was extensive upon release.



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